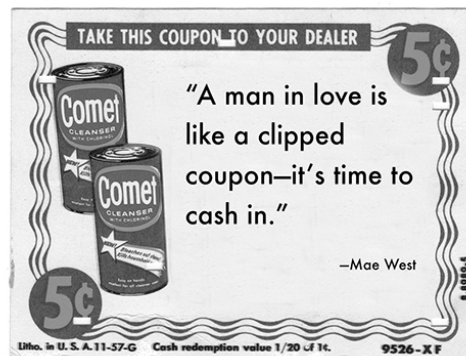


qualitative research methods to delve deep into the consumer psyche. A *New York Times* article in 1998 stated that he was the first to coin the term “focus group” and to stress the importance of image and persuasion in advertising.



According to Vance Packard, market research, or MR as he calls it in *The Hidden Persuaders*, took root as a serious movement in the late forties and early fifties. One of the first milestones of market research in printed form appeared in the April 1950 issue of the *Journal of Marketing* published by the American Marketing Association. That landmark issue contained four major articles dealing with the depth approach of market research. Within a few months, *Printer's Ink*, a merchandising journal, would run an article by James Vicary explaining how psychiatric methods could be applied to market research.

In an updated, and slightly twisted version of Packard's book, *The Ubiquitous Persuaders*, author George Parker points out that despite Packard's stressing Dichter's influence, Louis Cheskin may have had even more influence on modern methods of motivational research. In the early 1930s, Cheskin embarked on what would become a lifelong obsession to